FREE PREVIEW



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The Psychology of Hidden Intentions, Micro-Signals and Human Masks

by LEGENDCHIL

BEFORE YOU START

In 2018, a woman met a man on Tinder who said he was the son of a diamond tycoon. On their first date, he flew her on a private jet.

Then came weeks of constant messages, fast declarations, plans for the future. Then the crisis: enemies, blocked cards, an urgent request for money. She lent it. She wasn't the only one.

> *The signs were there from day one. She just didn't know what she was looking at.*

In this preview, you'll see the first ones.

IN THIS PREVIEW

- **All of Chapter 1** — the three masks and the gap that gives them away.
- **Part of Chapter 10** — love bombing, with the real case that opened this page.
- **What's in the full guide** — plus a code only for people who read to the end.

CHAPTER

01

The Three Masks and the Gap

Everyone you know is wearing a mask. Not out of malice — out of social survival. Nobody shows a stranger what they show their mother, and nobody shows their mother what they think alone at 3 a.m.

The mistake isn't that people wear masks. The mistake is confusing the mask with the face.

> **THE CASE**
>
> In 2014, Elizabeth Holmes was on the cover of Forbes: the youngest woman to become a self-made billionaire. She promised hundreds of tests from a single drop of blood. Black turtleneck, unblinking stare, a deep voice that, according to former colleagues, wasn't always her own. Investors, former Secretaries of State and one of America's largest pharmacy chains believed her. The technology never worked the way she claimed. In 2022 she was convicted of fraud. The signs were there from the start: huge claims, zero detail, irritation at technical questions. An almost perfect Competence Mask.

THE THREE LAYERS

— **Public Mask** — what they show strangers, clients, followers. Polished, rehearsed, controlled. The “CV” version.

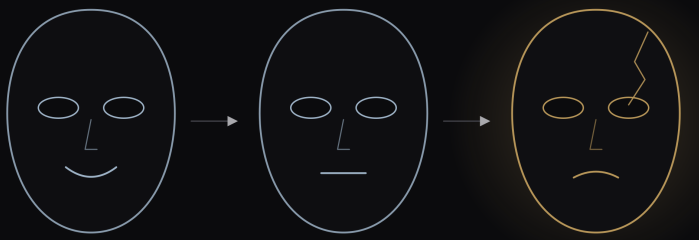
— **Social Mask** — what they show friends and colleagues. More relaxed, still filtered. Opinions, jokes and small irritations start to leak.

— **Private Face** — real fears, desires, resentments and ambitions. It only appears with time, intimacy or pressure.

Most people judge others by the Public Mask alone. That's why they get fooled so often.

FIG. 01

The 3 masks



The mask slips for microseconds. That's when you read.

WHY THIS MATTERS

If you mistake the mask for the face, you hand trust, time and money to a version someone rehearsed — and you only meet the real one once it has cost you. Knowing that masks exist doesn't make you suspicious. It makes you patient: you wait for the gap before you hand over what's yours. And it makes you fairer, because you realise most people wear a mask out of fear, not malice.

THE GAP IS THE SIGNAL

Don't try to guess someone's Private Face. Look for the **gap** — the distance between what a person says they are and what they repeatedly do.

— Says they value respect, but interrupts everyone.

— Says they're transparent, but tenses up at simple questions.

— Says money doesn't matter, but mentions prices in every conversation.

— Says they're “very loyal”, but trashes every old friend.

One gap is noise. A gap that repeats is information.

THREE MASKS TO RECOGNISE

— **The Victim Mask** — constant stories of injustice, never any personal responsibility, always looking for a rescuer. It turns your empathy into obligation.

— **The Competence Mask** — big claims without detail, a need to impress, irritation at concrete questions. It sells you an image and avoids verification.

— **The Loyalty Mask** — accelerated intimacy, excessive promises, “you're like a brother to me” after two weeks. It wants access before earning it.

> *People who need to convince you hard of who they are rarely are that.*

WHEN THE MASK SLIPS

Masks fall in three situations: **stress, surprise and frustration**. When someone loses, is contradicted or caught off guard, for one second you see the real face. Don't provoke these moments — notice them when

they happen naturally. How someone treats a waiter who got their order wrong says more than ten pleasant dinners.

USE THIS

PROTECT YOURSELF	Before you give someone new access — to your money, your secrets, your home — pick one thing they say they are and wait to see three behaviours that confirm it.
HELP SOMEONE	The Victim Mask often hides real pain. You don't have to be anyone's rescuer, but you can say: “That sounds hard. What can you do next?” You help them step out of the role without leaving them alone.

TODAY'S PRACTICE

Pick someone you talk to regularly. Write down three things they say about themselves. Over the next week, record only behaviours that confirm or contradict each one. At the end, you'll see where the gap is.

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Liked Chapter 1?

The full guide has 25 more chapters like it. The next one you'll read is about the tactic that woman never saw coming.

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CHAPTER

10

Love Bombing: the Love That Traps You

Flowers on day three. “You're the one” in week one. Messages all day. Plans for the future before they know your past.

It feels like the start of a film. Often it's the start of a trap.

> **THE CASE**
>
> Shimon Hayut called himself Simon Leviev, son of a diamond tycoon. He met women on Tinder and, on the very first date, flew them on a private jet. Then came constant messages, fast declarations, plans for the future. Weeks later came the crisis: “my enemies are after me”, blocked cards, an urgent request for money. According to the documentary “The Tinder Swindler” (Netflix, 2022), he took around 10 million dollars from his victims.

WHAT IT IS

Love bombing is a **flood of attention, affection and promises** at the start of a relationship — romantic, friendship or even professional. The goal isn't to love you. It's to create **emotional dependence** fast, before you have time to see who the person really is.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Love bombing uses the thing we want most — to be seen and loved — as bait. If you don't recognise it, you'll mistake the trap for the best

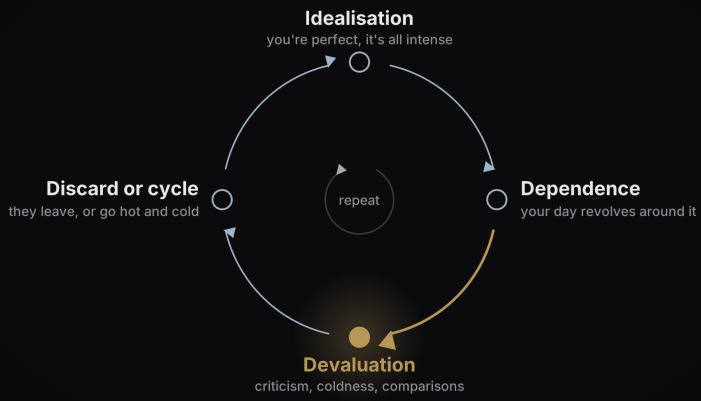
moment of your life and spend the following months trying to get it back.

THE PHASES

1. **Idealisation** — you're perfect. No one understands you like they do. Everything is intense, fast, magical.
2. **Dependence** — you get used to that dose of attention. Your day starts revolving around it.
3. **Devaluation** — the attention starts slipping. Criticism, coldness and comparisons appear. And you work harder to get back to phase 1.
4. **Discard or cycle** — they leave, or they alternate hot and cold to keep you hooked.

FIG. 06

The love bombing cycle



The cycle doesn't end. It speeds up.

THE SIGNS

— **Speed** — intimacy that should take months happens in days.

— **Disproportionate intensity** — expensive gifts, huge declarations, “soulmates” too early.

— **Fast-forwarded future** — moving in, trips, kids, business partnerships, all before there's any foundation.

END OF THIS CHAPTER'S PREVIEW

The other 3 signs — including the one almost everyone ignores — are in the full guide. So is how to tell real love from love bombing, and what to do if it's happening to you.

Get the full guide with 20% off →

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Inside the full guide

Part I · Read	How to tell when someone's lying without falling for the myths (crossed arms mean nothing). Feet, voice, words, text messages. Reading any room in 60 seconds.
Part II · The Predators	Why they choose you. The Dark Triad. The 6 signs of love bombing. Isolation, gaslighting, triangulation — and the mechanism that stops you leaving.
Part III · Power	Cialdini's 6 triggers that make you say “yes”. Manipulation at work and in families. Real vs. fake interest. The 5 signs that come before betrayal.
Part IV · Defense	Ready-made lines for every tactic. Non-negotiable boundaries. How to leave and not go back. How to help someone who's trapped. A 7-day training protocol.

26 chapters · 10 illustrations · 10 real cases and studies · 50-sign checklist

Bonus: printable 50-sign cheat sheet + the 15 red flags test.

A PEEK AT THE FINAL CHECKLIST

1. Gap between who they say they are and what they do
2. Sudden change from baseline
3. Three deviations tied to the same topic
4. Contempt — one lip corner
5. A smile with only the mouth
6. A face that contradicts the words
7. Pressed lips
8. Feet pointing to the exit
9. Hands disappearing on a specific topic
10. A gesture that arrives after the word
11. Long pause before a simple answer
12. Over-explaining
13. "Honestly", "I swear", "why would I lie?"
14. Answering a question with a question
15. Shrinking messages and slower replies, for weeks
16. Accelerated intimacy

+ 40 more signs in the full guide



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